

The venue was packed to the hilt throughout the event



Killing it @ SuperNOVA Gaming Carnival

Coming to a city near you

By Mithun "Barbarian_Monkey" Mohandas

2016 is turning out to be a great year for the Indian gaming scene and SuperNova Gaming Carnival epitomises that aspect quite well. It's how you'd expect a gaming event to be held. We headed down to Bengaluru for the first leg of their five-city SuperNova Gaming Carnival and it had a mix of gaming, cosplay, music and comedy. Essentially, it had something for every type of gamer, whether you're into hardcore gaming or just testing the waters. Conceptualised by Novaplay, an upcoming gaming platform and partnered with Nodwin Gaming, OML and ESL, the highlight of the SuperNova Gaming Carnival is the Counter Strike: Global Offensive competition featuring some of the top professional teams in the country.

They way the event was held was what grabbed our attention. Everything from getting a leased line for the pro-level competition, the big-ass displays, great casters, apt venue, good hardware, excellent production quality and did we mention the free food? And if the CS:GO competition wasn't enough to drag your sorry ass down to LOFT 38 in Bengaluru then the cosplay competition surely would have drawn a few eyeballs. While there were a few issues with the cosplayers not getting enough space to showcase their get-ups the competition as a whole was pretty entertaining with

Prady Das taking the crown thanks to his impressive Licker cosplay from the Resident Evil series.

The day started off with the CS:GO matches on one side while qualifiers for the following rounds were being held on the other side. Team Brutality got off to an easy start against Crash Kid Legends and they kept up with their winning streak till they sat down against Overcome. Not that Overcome won but they turned out to be the best opponents against Brutality who weren't in the lead till mid-game. After the gaming tourney, the cosplay competition took centre-stage. Who won? Team Brutality did, against FungFuPandits. However, they day didn't end there, comic Abish Mathew took to the floor and had everyone in splits.

We sat down with Amitesh Rao, CEO of NovaPlay, he had this to say about the event, "We are delighted to launch the first-of-its kind multi city gaming carnival that aims to create a space for a larger gaming community in India. This will also be an opportunity for professional gamers to unleash their talent at a larger platform. I am confident that by bringing together pro-gamers and mainstream entertainment under one roof we will take the Indian eSports and entertainment industry to next the level." *



▲ Abish Mathew entertaining the crowd with his stand-up act



▲ All the action was beamed onto the big screen



▲ Winners of the Bangalore leg of SuperNOVA Gaming Carnival - Team Brutality



▲ The Cosplay Competition was one of the highlights of the event